

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

202 E White St, Champaign, Illinois, 61820 | sangjun2@illinois.edu | www.linkedin.com/in/sangjunko

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	Champaign, Illinois
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.92/4.00)	January 2023 - May 2025
Master of Science in Statistics	August 2025 - May 2027 (Expected)
- Mathematics Minor - Coursework: Data Science Programming Methods(STAT447), Advanced Data Analysis(STAT448), Statistical Modeling II(STAT426), Statistical Data Management(STAT440), Statistics and Probability II(STAT410), Elementary Real Analysis(MATH444), Linear Algebra(MATH257)	

WORK EXPERIENCE

STAT107 Data Science Discovery	Champaign, Illinois
<i>Undergraduate Course Assistant</i>	August 2023 - Present
- Assist over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs - Manage Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials - Collaborate with a team of 100+ staff and 2 professors in weekly meetings	
STAT443 Professional Statistics	Champaign, Illinois
<i>Undergraduate Course Assistant</i>	January 2025 - Present
- Grade assignments and provide feedback to 20+ students on statistical analysis and consulting using Canvas LMS - Act as a client in mock projects, simulating real-world consulting challenges	
Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences	Champaign, Illinois
<i>AI/ML Intern Team Leader</i>	January 2024 - December 2024
- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings - Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT	
KM Internacional S.A.	Managua, Nicaragua
<i>Intern</i>	May 2023 - August 2023
- Oversaw comprehensive inventory management and streamlined administrative tasks for a small textile company - Lead a team of three workers to achieve a 98% accuracy rate in record-keeping and a 15% reduction in operational costs	

PROJECTS/AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model	September 2024 - December 2024
- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records - Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators	
3rd Place, 2024 CIC Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)	September 2024
- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss - Proposed interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis	
Paraphrase Detection	July 2024
- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset - Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities	

SKILLS

Languages:	English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer:	Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib, Seaborn, BERT, Random Forest, XGBoost, Gradio R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate), Tableau (Basic), SQL (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates:	Data Science DISCOVERY, Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting	September 2024 - December 2024
Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits	